Name: _____ **Group:** _____ **Date:** _____

4 ESO · SEASONS & CELEBRATIONS · ROUTE PRO

Learning Path 5 · Plan the day

✏️ Paper worksheet: do the same activities as on the computer. Write your answers and circle the letter of the right option. Do it without notes the first time.

🎯 My goal

Before you start: think about your last recall or checkpoint. What do you want to get better at in this Learning Path?

_____

1 Recall: Learning Paths 2–4

Type the answers without looking.

1. A tradition that is centuries old: time-_____
2. The custom is _____ to date back to the 1300s. (reported)
3. Sources citing each other so a claim looks stronger: _____ reporting
4. Writing that keeps a source's structure but swaps a few words: p_____
5. Under no circumstances _____ you light fireworks indoors. (1 word)
6. The festival _____ (EVOLVE) from a harvest ritual into a street party. (past)
7. Two things looking alike does not _____ that one came from the other.
8. The lamps _____ (SYMBOL) the triumph of light over darkness.

2 C2 vocabulary: organising an event

Explore, go through the cards and complete the sentences. Precise planning language for your proposal.

English	Meaning	Example
Making it happen		
pull off	to succeed in doing something difficult	Nobody thought we could pull it off in two weeks.
iron out	to solve the small remaining problems	We still need to iron out a few details.
liaise with	to work together and keep each other informed	One student will liaise with the primary school.
rope in	to persuade someone to help	We roped in my cousin's band.
oversee	to watch and direct work to check it is done well	Mr Vidal has agreed to oversee the stalls.
allocate	to give a share of something for a purpose	Each stall is allocated a table and two students.
run smoothly	to happen without problems	We want the day to run smoothly.
When things go wrong		
contingency plan	a plan for what to do if something goes wrong	Our contingency plan is to use the gym.

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English	Meaning	Example
a fallback	an option you can use if the first one fails	The playground is our fallback if the hall is full.
fall through	to fail to happen	If the band falls through, we will use a playlist.
at short notice	with very little warning	Volunteers may be needed at short notice.
a bottleneck	a point where things slow down because too much is happening	The entrance could become a bottleneck.
logistics	the practical organisation of an event	The logistics are the hardest part.
Inclusion		
inclusive	including everyone, not excluding any group	an inclusive event
accommodate	to provide what someone needs	We will accommodate dietary requirements.
dietary requirements	what people can or cannot eat for health or religious reasons	All food will be labelled for dietary requirements.
opt out	to choose not to take part	Families who prefer not to take part can opt out.
token	done only to look good, not seriously meant	We want real participation, not a token gesture.

Words you will hear or read (no need to learn them): risk assessment · capacity · footfall · signage · stakeholders

Study them: cover the meaning column and define each word in your own words. Then complete the sentences without looking at the table.

Complete the sentences

1. If the band falls _____, we will use a playlist.
2. We still need to _____ out a few details before Monday.
3. One student will _____ with the primary school about the visit.
4. Our _____ plan, if it rains, is to move into the gym.
5. We managed to _____ in three parents to help with the food.
6. All food will be labelled for _____ requirements.
7. Families who prefer not to take part can _____ out.
8. Nobody thought we could pull it _____ in two weeks.
9. We want an _____ (INCLUDE) event, not a token gesture.
10. The _____ (LOGISTIC) are the hardest part of the job.

3 Listening: student council meeting

The same meeting as your class, with C2 Proficiency Listening questions: implied meaning, how decisions are reached and what is left unresolved.

🎧 **Student council meeting** · If you cannot listen to it, read transcript 1 at the end of the worksheet (twice, as if you were listening).

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1. Why does Laia open with “we need a plan today”?
   a) to show she has already made the plan **b)** to complain that Omar is late
   c) to set a clear goal because of a deadline **d)** to suggest postponing the meeting
2. What does Omar’s answer about food (“I think a lot of parents will help”) suggest?
   a) The parents have already promised to help. **b)** The food will be paid for by the school.
   c) It is a prediction, not yet something arranged. **d)** He does not want to deal with the food.
3. How would you describe the roles in the conversation?
   a) Both are equally unprepared. **b)** Omar leads; Laia takes notes. **c)** They disagree on most points.
   d) Laia leads with questions; Omar supplies the details.
4. Which part of the plan is the least secure?
   a) the date **b)** the location **c)** the music, which depends on a phone call **d)** the decorations
5. When Laia says “One problem: the hall is small”, she is…
   a) anticipating a risk **b)** changing the subject **c)** refusing the plan **d)** criticising Omar
6. What does the meeting NOT address that a head teacher might ask about?
   a) the decorations **b)** the date **c)** cost and supervision **d)** the theme of the event
7. Laia’s final remark (“the best day of the term”) mainly serves to…
   a) end the meeting on a positive, motivating note **b)** ask for more ideas **c)** set a measurable target
   d) compare it with other events in detail

4 Real video: how festivals build communities

A real TEDx talk recorded at the Burning Man festival. It is spontaneous speech, with hesitations and asides, so listen for the speaker’s argument and attitude rather than every word. Think about what it means for the day you are planning.

🎧 **How Festivals Build Real Communities** · YouTube video: your teacher will play it for you (youtube.com/watch?v=GdOHIy8y7pE).

1. What does the speaker say modern festivals like Burning Man are for?
   a) A separate time and place to experiment with living by a set of values
   b) Making money for the organisers **c)** Remembering an ancient religion **d)** Escaping from all rules
2. How does he use the origin of the word “utopia”?
   a) To explain where the festival takes place
   b) To argue that the ideal community can never actually be reached
   c) To show that Burning Man is a Greek tradition **d)** To prove that festivals are a waste of time
3. How were ancient festivals different, in his view?
   a) They had no religious side. **b)** They were more democratic than modern ones.
   c) They were prescribed from above, so there was no utopian promise.
   d) They were only for young people.
4. For him, where does the real value of Carnival lie?
   a) In the year-round community work, such as building floats and preparing the balls
   b) In the single day when everything is allowed **c)** In the period of Lent afterwards
   d) In the money it brings to cities

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5. Why does he mention the Altamont festival?
   a) As an example of a serious error of judgement, the kind organisers will always make
   b) To compare it favourably with Woodstock **c)** To praise the Hells Angels
   d) To show that festivals should be banned
6. He says striving for the festival's principles is "asymptotic", not Sisyphean. What does he mean?
   a) You keep getting closer without ever arriving, and that is worthwhile.
   b) You will succeed if you work hard enough. **c)** You keep failing and starting again for nothing.
   d) You should give up when the task is too hard.
7. What does he see as the only real failure?
   a) Complaining about the organisers **b)** Not reaching the festival's ideals
   c) Making mistakes when planning **d)** Walking away from the community
8. Which lesson for your Celebration Day best matches his talk?
   a) Let one leader decide everything to avoid mistakes. **b)** Copy the format of a famous festival exactly.
   c) Keep the event as short as possible.
   d) Plan for things to go wrong, and keep everyone involved in improving the day.

5 Listen again: getting ready for a celebration

Listen to Mei from LP3: how does her family get ready, and who does what? It will help you plan your day.

🎧 **Mei: Lunar New Year** · If you cannot listen to it, read transcript 2 at the end of the worksheet (twice, as if you were listening).

1. What does Mei's family do a few days before?
   a) They buy new clothes. **b)** They clean the whole flat. **c)** They send invitations.
2. Who comes from Liverpool?
   a) her brother **b)** her grandparents **c)** her cousins
3. What do they make together?
   a) lanterns **b)** dumplings **c)** posters
4. What do the children get?
   a) red envelopes with money **b)** sweets **c)** new toys
5. Where do they watch the dragon dance?
   a) in the school hall **b)** at home **c)** in Chinatown
6. What is the best moment for Mei?
   a) cleaning the flat **b)** the dragon dance **c)** making dumplings together
7. Why do they clean the flat?
   a) because guests are coming **b)** to sweep away bad luck **c)** because it's a family rule
8. Which idea from Mei could make your event feel welcoming?
   a) an activity everyone does together, like making food **b)** a long talk about history
   c) a quiz with prizes only for the winners
9. "Not every family celebrates it in the same way." Why is this useful for your event plan?
   a) It means you should not include Lunar New Year. **b)** It shows that the customs are not real.
   c) It reminds you to show customs without saying everyone does them.

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10. “Nobody is looking at their phone.” What does Mei mean?

a) Everyone is really together and enjoying it. **b)** She has lost her phone.

c) Phones are not allowed at dinner.

6 Shadowing · Student council meeting

Repeat part of the listening just behind the speaker, like a shadow.

How it works

Your teacher plays the clip three times: first read while you listen, then mumble the words along, then say them aloud just behind the speaker.

Laia: OK, everyone. We’re meeting the head teacher on Monday, so we need a plan today.

Omar: Right. The event is going to be about festivals of light: Diwali, Hanukkah, Lunar New Year and Christmas.

Laia: Good. When is it?

Omar: It’s on Friday the eleventh of December. School finishes at two, so the event starts at ten and finishes at one thirty.

Laia: Where’s it going to take place?

Omar: In the school hall. There will be four stalls, one for each festival.

Laia: What about food?

Omar: I’ll ask the families. I think a lot of parents will help.

7 The future at C2: formal arrangements and inverted conditionals

Key word transformations (Reading and Use of English, Part 4): 3–8 words including the word in CAPITALS.

How it works

Formal arrangements: *The event is to take place in the hall. · The guests are due to arrive at ten. · We are on the point of confirming the band.*

Future perfect / continuous: *By ten, the stalls will have been set up. · At eleven, the band will be playing.*

Inverted conditionals (formal, very common in proposals): *Should it rain, we will… · Were the hall to be full, we would… · Had we known, we would have…*

Certainty: *It is bound to rain. · There is every chance that… · It is unlikely that…*

1. If it rains, we will use the gym. SHOULD → _____, we will use the gym.
2. If the hall were full, we would open the gym. WERE → _____ full, we would open the gym.
3. The event has been arranged for 11 December. TAKE → The event _____ on 11 December.
4. We will finish setting up the stalls before ten. HAVE → By ten we _____ the stalls.
5. We are about to confirm the band. POINT → We are _____ the band.
6. I’m sure there will be problems with the sound. BOUND → There _____ problems with the sound.

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7. If we had known about the exam, we would have chosen another date. HAD → _____ about the exam, we would have chosen another date.
8. It is very likely that families will come. CHANCE → There _____ families will come.
9. At eleven the band will be in the middle of its set. PLAYING → At eleven the band _____.
10. Please contact Laia if you need anything. SHOULD → _____ anything, please contact Laia.

8 Multiple-choice cloze: collocations

Reading and Use of English, Part 1: choose the word that fits each gap. All four options are similar in meaning, so the answer depends on collocation and grammar.

1. Organising the stalls was no mean ___.
   a) act **b)** deed **c)** feat **d)** achievement
2. The head teacher gave the plan the green ___.
   a) signal **b)** card **c)** light **d)** flag
3. We need to ___ a balance between fun and learning.
   a) make **b)** hit **c)** reach **d)** strike
4. Every detail was planned down to the last ___.
   a) second **b)** instant **c)** moment **d)** minute
5. The event will ___ place in the school hall.
   a) have **b)** take **c)** hold **d)** find
6. At the ___ of being repetitive: please label all the food.
   a) threat **b)** risk **c)** danger **d)** chance
7. The idea quickly ___ momentum among students.
   a) raised **b)** grew **c)** collected **d)** gathered
8. We will bear in ___ that not all families celebrate.
   a) memory **b)** mind **c)** thought **d)** head

9 Piece 4: a proposal (C2 Proficiency Writing, Part 2)

This text is the fourth piece of your final product. A proposal is written for a committee that has to decide: be clear, persuasive and realistic.

Your task

Your school's management committee has invited students to submit **proposals** for a celebration day in December. Write a proposal (280–320 words) for your group's event. Describe what the day would involve, explain how it would make every student and family feel welcome, anticipate at least two practical problems with realistic solutions, and persuade the committee that the event is worth the time it takes away from lessons. Use headings.

Model (don't copy it)

Structure only. **Introduction** (purpose in one sentence) · **The event** (what, when, where, who; future forms) · **Making everyone welcome** (two concrete measures, each with its reason) · **Practical considerations** (two risks + inverted conditionals: *Should it rain…*) · **Why it is worth it** (the educational value, answering the "lost lessons" objection) · Recommendation in one sentence.

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10 Speaking: plan your answers to tough questions (no recording)

The question

The committee asks: “Isn’t a day like this just a nice break from lessons?”

Two more questions you might get: “What if some families object?” · “How will you know it worked?”

C2 Proficiency Speaking, Part 3, the discussion stage: the examiner asks follow-up questions that you cannot prepare. What you can prepare is a method.

🧭 Strategy

The PREP method for unprepared questions: **P**oint (answer in one sentence) → **R**eason → **E**xample → **P**oint again, slightly developed. Under pressure, most candidates give the example first and never get to the point.

Acknowledge, don’t defend: a hostile question usually contains something true. Agree with that part first (*It’s true that it isn’t a normal lesson…*), then turn it. This sounds confident, not defensive.

Buying time: *That’s a fair challenge. · I’d put it slightly differently… · If I understand you correctly, you’re asking whether…*

Your plan · Write notes, not full sentences: this is the thinking you would do in the exam’s preparation time.

Your first reaction to the question (honestly)

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What is true in the question? (acknowledge)

Your PREP answer: point · reason · example · point again

One of the other two questions: your point in one sentence

A model plan

(read it only after you have written your plan)

Acknowledge: It's true it isn't a normal lesson, and students will enjoy it.
Point: But enjoying something and learning from it aren't opposites.
Reason: Students research, check sources, write a formal proposal and explain a culture to an audience: that is the curriculum, applied.
Example: our research cards had to compare three sources; we found two websites copying each other.
Point again: So it's less a break from lessons than a test of what the lessons were for.

"How will you know it worked?" Point: we will ask visitors two questions at the exit and count how many families came back for the evening part.

What would you change in your plan now? (one sentence)

11 Talk: planning meeting

A student council member asks you about your celebration day plan.

Your task

Answer with all the future forms, and when there is a problem, offer a solution (If it rains, we'll…).

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1. **What are we going to do on the day?**

2. **Where is it going to take place?**

3. **We need music. Who can bring it?**

4. **What time does it start?**

5. **When are we meeting the head teacher?**

6. **How can we make everyone feel welcome?**

7. **What if it rains and the hall is too small?**

Then · Have the conversation aloud with a classmate: they ask and you answer, then swap.

Model

We're going to set up four stalls, one for each festival of light, and there will be music, food and a lantern workshop. It's going to take place in the school hall, and the event starts at ten. I'll ask my cousin's band, and if they can't come, I'll make a playlist. We're meeting the head teacher on Monday morning. To make everyone feel welcome, we'll explain that not every family celebrates the same way. And if it rains, we'll open the gym too, so nobody feels crowded.

🔁 **How did it go?**

What helped me most?

What do I need to review?

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📚 Study guide: prepare for Checkpoint 3 and the final exam

How to study what you learn in this Learning Path, and practice that works like the checkpoint and looks like the exam. The answer key is at the end of each activity.

How to study

🧠 Test yourself, don't reread
Close your notes and try to remember: write the words, say the rule, answer the questions. Then check. Rereading and highlighting feel useful, but you remember much less.
Retrieval practice · Roediger & Karpicke 2006; Dunlosky et al. 2013

📅 Spread it out
Three short sessions of 15 minutes on different days work better than one long session the day before.
Spacing · Cepeda et al. 2006

🔀 Mix it up
Practise similar things together so you learn to choose the right one for each sentence.
Interleaving · Rohrer & Taylor 2007

✅ Check and fix at once
Mark your answers with the key straight away and write each wrong answer again, correctly.
Feedback · Hattie & Timperley 2007

💬 Say why
For every answer, say the reason: "on, because it's a date." Explaining makes the rule stick.
Self-explanation · Dunlosky et al. 2013

😴 Sleep on it
Your brain stores what you learn while you sleep. A short self-test and a good night's sleep beat studying late the night before.
Sleep and memory · Diekelmann & Born 2010

My plan

1. **Today** · Close this page and write from memory: five words for planning an event and three sentences about a plan (going to, will, Present Continuous). Then check.
2. **In 2–3 days** · Do "Practise for Checkpoint 3" below. Look at the key and write again what you got wrong.
3. **Before Checkpoint 3** · Go over the flashcards: only the ones you still miss.
4. **The week before the exam** · Do the exam-style practice in every Learning Path, then the Sample exam. Repeat only the parts you failed.

What comes up

Checkpoint 3 (LS1, Learning Paths 1–3 and 5): short gaps, collocations and word formation, one question at a time, about 45 seconds each, no going back and no notes. You do it once, and you must stay on the page: if you leave it, it is sent. It opens the next Learning Path.
Final exam: the C2 version: listening for attitude and implication, a long reading, vocabulary (multiple-choice cloze and word formation), grammar (open cloze and key word transformations) and a formal letter.

Practise for Checkpoint 3

One question at a time · 45 s

It works like the real checkpoint: 10 questions, one at a time, about 45 seconds each, with no going back and no notes. This is only practice: nothing is sent, you can repeat it, and at the end you see your answers and the key.

On paper: cover the questions and uncover them one at a time, about 45 seconds each, with no going back.

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1. We're running out of time, so let's get the _____ rolling.
2. Were the band _____ cancel, we would use a playlist.
3. By Friday we will _____ sent all the invitations.
4. There is _____ to be a problem with the sound: there always is.
5. The stalls need to be set up well in _____.
6. Let's not set the date in _____ until the head confirms.
7. The event was a _____ (RESOUND) success.
8. We have a back-_____ plan in case it rains.
9. Under no _____ should food be left uncovered.
10. The head teacher is _____ to approve the plan: she loves the idea.

Like the exam: Listening

4 × 2 points

Listen to the recording from this Learning Path once without the questions. Then read the questions and listen again.

🎧 The recording from this Learning Path · if you cannot listen to it, read transcript 1 at the end.

1. Laia's opening line mainly shows that she… [2 points]

a) is aware of a deadline **b)** wants to cancel the event **c)** is annoyed with Omar **d)** has already spoken to the head

2. Which part of the plan is already arranged rather than only intended? [2 points]

a) using the gym **b)** getting food from the families **c)** sending the invitations on Wednesday **d)** music from Omar's cousin

3. Laia mentions the small hall in order to… [2 points]

a) bring the meeting to an end **b)** criticise Omar's choice **c)** suggest a different date **d)** test the plan against a likely problem

4. Overall, the tone of the meeting is… [2 points]

a) brisk and constructive **b)** tense and argumentative **c)** formal and distant **d)** vague and unfocused

Like the exam: Vocabulary

1 point · gaps 2 points

Choose the right word, or type it.

1. We need to ___ out the details before Monday. [1 point]

a) flatten **b)** iron **c)** smooth **d)** press

2. The whole day went off without a ___. [1 point]

a) hatch **b)** hitch **c)** hinge **d)** hutch

3. _____ (ATTEND) was much higher than expected. [2 points]

4. The event has been _____ (THOROUGH) planned. [2 points]

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Like the exam: Grammar 1 point · gaps 2 points

Choose the right form, or type it.

1. If the band doesn’t come, we’ll use a playlist. SHOULD → _____, we’ll use a playlist. [2 points]

2. We will finish decorating before nine. HAVE → By nine we _____ decorating. [2 points]

3. Open cloze: The event is _____ take place on 11 December. [2 points]

4. Open cloze: _____ happens, we’ll keep the stalls open until 13.30. [2 points]

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📚 Study guide: answer key

Look at them only when you have finished each activity.

Practise for Checkpoint 3

1. **ball** · get the ball rolling = start.
2. **to** · Were + subject + to + infinitive.
3. **have** · Future perfect.
4. **bound** · be bound to = be certain to.
5. **advance** · in advance.
6. **stone** · set in stone = fixed.
7. **resounding** · a resounding success.
8. **up** · a back-up plan.
9. **circumstances** · Under no circumstances + inversion.
10. **likely** · be likely / sure to.

Like the exam: Listening

1. **is aware of a deadline** · “We’re meeting the head teacher on Monday, so we need a plan today.”
2. **sending the invitations on Wednesday** · “We’re sending them on Wednesday” = an arrangement.
3. **test the plan against a likely problem** · She raises a risk so they can solve it.
4. **brisk and constructive** · Short questions, quick answers, solutions.

Like the exam: Vocabulary

1. **iron** · iron out the details.
2. **hitch** · without a hitch = with no problems.
3. **attendance** · attend → attendance.
4. **thoroughly** · thorough → thoroughly.

Like the exam: Grammar

1. **should the band not come** · Should + subject + verb (inverted conditional).
2. **will have finished** · Future perfect.
3. **to** · be to + infinitive for official plans.
4. **whatever** · Whatever happens…

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Transcripts (only if you cannot listen)

Transcript 1 · Student council meeting

Transcript 2 · Mei: Lunar New Year

Mei: Hi! I'm Mei. I'm fifteen and I live in Manchester. My favourite celebration is Lunar New Year. It usually takes place in late January or February. A few days before, we clean the whole flat to sweep away bad luck. My brother hates that part! On New Year's Eve, my grandparents come from Liverpool and we have a huge reunion dinner. We make dumplings together, all of us around the kitchen table. For me, that's the best moment. Everybody is talking and laughing, and nobody is looking at their phone. Then the children get red envelopes with money, and we go to Chinatown to watch the dragon dance. It's so loud and colourful! Not every family celebrates it in the same way. But for us, it's about being together and starting the year with good luck.

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